

DESTRUCTION OF L'ORIENT

The French warship *L'Orient* explodes during the Battle of the Nile, on May 19, 1798, killing Vice Admiral Brueys and most of his crew. Both sides were so shocked by the explosion that firing ceased for several minutes. In the center of the picture, British warship *Swiftsure* is rocked by a wave caused by the blast. In the foreground sailors cling to wreckage, while others are hauled from the water.